



Student to complete:

Family name	
Other names	
Student number	
Table number	

**MGNT110
Introduction to Management
Wollongong**

**Examination Paper
Spring & Trimester 3, 2025**

Exam duration 2 hours

Weighting 40%

Items permitted by examiner Nil

Aids supplied Nil

Directions to students This examination consists of **TWO (2)** sections and is worth 40% of your overall mark. Your exam will be marked out of 100. All sections are compulsory.

1. **Section A: Short answer questions** (worth 30 marks). This section consists of **ten (10)** questions; each question is worth 3 marks. All questions must be attempted. **Use the space below each question to write your answer.**
2. **Section B: Reflection** (worth 70 marks). This section consists of a **short case study**; students must write a reflection based on the case study. **Use the 6-page booklet to provide your response.** You are not expected to use all pages in this booklet. Use as much space as you need to answer the question fully. Quality of analysis and clarity of reflection are more important than length.

Section A: Short Answer Questions (Worth 30 marks)

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Question 1.

(3 marks)

What is groupthink, and why can it be harmful in organisational decision-making?

Question 2.

(3 marks)

What was one key contribution to management thought from Mary Parker Follett? Provide a contemporary example.

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Question 3.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

Question 4.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

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Question 5.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

Question 6.

(3 marks)

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Question 7.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

Question 8.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

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Question 9.

(3 marks)

An organisation chooses to focus all its resources on refining existing products that already sell well, rather than experimenting with new ideas. Is this strategy "knowledge exploration" or "knowledge exploitation"? Why, and what are the potential long-term risks?

Question 10.

(3 marks)

Question goes here.

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Section B: Case Study

(Worth 70 marks)

Read the case study provided and imagine that you are the junior employee in the scenario.

Write a first-person reflective essay that explores your feelings, evaluation, analysis, conclusions, and actions in response to the situation.

Use the Graham Gibbs' (1988) reflective framework to guide your structure (feelings, evaluation, analysis, conclusion, action plan). The case study itself serves as the description stage, so you do not need to restate it in your response.

Focus question

What caused the conflict in this situation, and how could you respond professionally while staying true to your values?

Your reflection should:

- Interpret and evaluate the events in the case.
- Apply relevant management theories discussed in lectures and the textbook, especially those related to **ethics and corporate social responsibility**.
- Consider your personal response, assumptions, and what you would do differently in future situations, if this were you.

You must use evidence from the case and cite the case to support your reflection. You are not expected to cite academic references or provide a reference list. However, mentioning the names of seminal authors, where appropriate, will demonstrate your business knowledge.

You are expected to demonstrate thoughtful analysis, critical insight, and an understanding of management complexity.

Use the booklet provided to write your response. You may also annotate or make notes in the case study to assist with your reading and analysis. These notes will not be marked.

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Case study

I recently joined Brightside Creative, a mid-sized marketing agency, as a graduate account coordinator. I'm mostly responsible for preparing drafts of campaign briefs and coordinating feedback from different teams. It's fast-paced, and I've really enjoyed learning from experienced staff.

Last week, I was asked to help draft messaging for a rebranding campaign for a client that makes eco-friendly cleaning products. I worked closely with Hannah, a senior content strategist, and drafted some sample taglines and social media copy. I tried to make the language accessible and consumer-focused, drawing on what I learned at uni about ethical branding. I even included a few lines that gently challenged "greenwashing" and emphasised transparency, which I thought aligned with the client's values (Appendix A).

In our team meeting, Hannah cut me off partway through presenting and said, "This is off-brief. The client doesn't want a lecture—they want a clean, uplifting tone. We're not here to do their ethics strategy." Everyone went quiet, and we moved on.

After the meeting, she forwarded me a revised version that stripped out all the messaging about environmental responsibility. Her comment in the margin read, "Stick to the vibe. Don't editorialise" (Appendix B).

Later that day, I tried to bring it up casually with Hannah, and said I felt that authenticity was part of good marketing. She replied, "Well, this job is about giving the client what they want. Not what we think they should want." She didn't say it aggressively, but I could tell we had fundamentally different values when it came to what marketing is for.

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It wasn't just about the message—it felt personal. Like we weren't just disagreeing on content, but on what mattered.

Appendices

Appendix A: Excerpt from draft social media copy (prepared by you)

"Our impact matters. At [Client Name], sustainability isn't a buzzword—it's a promise. We'll never greenwash or hide behind vague claims. You deserve better."

Appendix B: Comment from Hannah on shared document

"Stick to the vibe. Don't editorialise. The client wants simple and light. Let's not overcomplicate the message."

END OF EXAMINATION

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